LENA VARGA-HOLM

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Halden Pay
Data Platform Hiring Team

Application: Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform

Dear Hiring Team,

Your emphasis on reusable frameworks rather than one-off pipelines matches my approach to data engineering: well-tested pipelines, clear data contracts and warehouses that analysts can trust. With 9 years of experience building batch and streaming platforms, including transaction reconciliation and finance data warehouses in payments, I bring directly relevant experience to Halden Pay's Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the ingestion layer spanning approximately 140 Airflow DAGs into Snowflake. I migrated transformation logic from stored procedures to more than 420 dbt models, with tests on every model, reducing nightly runtime from 5h10 to 1h35. By introducing JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product teams and the data team, I also helped reduce broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine per month to two. These results reflect the combination of platform operation, performance improvement and enforceable data quality standards your team needs.

At Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark reconciliation jobs processing approximately 1.2 TB daily on AWS EMR, designed a Redshift star schema for finance and risk, and implemented Great Expectations checks on critical finance tables. I also developed a reusable Python library for S3 and Glue catalog access used by four teams. My cloud experience is in AWS rather than Google Cloud, alongside Snowflake, Docker and GitHub Actions. This provides a relevant foundation in cloud data platforms, while my Airflow, dbt, Python and SQL experience aligns directly with your engineering stack.

Halden Pay's stated values of Together and Ownership are reflected in how I work with product teams on data contracts, mentor two engineers and run weekly platform office hours. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how this experience could support a reliable shared platform for your analysts, data scientists and product teams. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm